

KidsLearnAI

PYTHON & AI FOR KIDS

INTERN INTERVIEW CHEAT SHEET

A complete word-for-word guide for the Curriculum & Content Support / Instructor
Intern interview

30-minute structured interview | Fall 2026 | Prepared August 24, 2026

The hiring lens

You are not hiring a software engineer. You are hiring someone who can hold the attention of a 10-year-old on Zoom, explain Python accurately and simply, support curriculum work reliably, and protect children's safety and privacy.

Keep this PDF open or printed. Text inside green boxes is written for you to say aloud. Text marked 'Listen for' is for your evaluation only.

60-second setup before they join

- [] Open the candidate's application and resume. Circle one specific detail to mention in your welcome.
- [] Write the candidate's name, interview date, and your decision deadline at the top of the scorecard.
- [] Keep a timer visible. Protect the mini-teach and safeguarding questions if time runs short.
- [] Have the debugging code ready to paste into the video-call chat.
- [] Remember: the interview is a two-way conversation. Be warm, direct, and honest about the startup environment and funding contingency.

The 30-minute run of show

Time	Section	Purpose
00-03	Welcome and company	Settle them in; explain Kids Learn AI and the role.
03-08	Background and motivation	Why teaching, why kids, and evidence of communication.
08-14	Python check	Simple explanation plus live debugging.
14-20	Mini-teach	Highest-signal test: teach an if-statement to a 10-year-old.
20-24	Classroom and safety	One scenario plus the mandatory safeguarding question.
24-28	Logistics and VFC	Verify schedule, setup, eligibility, and funding understanding.
28-30	Candidate questions and close	Answer clearly; explain next steps and timeline.

If you are running late

Shorten the motivation and logistics sections. Do not skip the mini-teach or safeguarding question. Those two sections reveal the most about classroom readiness and risk.

Your opening posture

- Friendly and calm, not overly formal.
- Let the candidate finish answers; use one follow-up when the example is vague.
- Ask the same core questions of every candidate for fairness.
- Take short factual notes, not personality labels.

What to say about the company

SAY THIS

"Kids Learn AI is a Canadian education-technology startup operating under Opyjo Consulting Inc. We help children ages 9 to 13 learn real Python and responsible AI through live, small-group online classes and a purpose-built learning platform. Our goal is to help children move from simply consuming technology to understanding, questioning, and creating with it."

SAY THIS

"The learning experience is human-led. Students work on hands-on coding projects, quizzes, AI concept activities, and guided practice, while a live instructor helps them debug, ask questions, and build confidence. We also teach age-appropriate ideas about bias, privacy, safety, and responsible use of AI."

SAY THIS

"We currently have a continuing Term 2 group and are preparing a new beginner cohort for September. Classes are intentionally small, with a maximum of six students, because the quality of feedback and trust with families matter more to us than filling a large webinar."

Founder story - optional 20-second version

OPTIONAL FOUNDER SCRIPT

"I created Kids Learn AI because children should understand the technology shaping their world. As a builder and lead instructor, I want each lesson to be practical, welcoming, and child-first: explain ideas clearly, make space for questions, and turn small wins into lasting confidence."

What makes Kids Learn AI different

- Live teachers and real-time help, not only pre-recorded videos.
- Real Python from day one, taught through age-appropriate projects.
- Responsible AI, privacy, bias, and safety are built into the curriculum.
- Small classes and parent trust are central to the experience.
- A structured two-year curriculum and learning platform support consistent delivery as the instructor team grows.

Do not overstate

Be honest about the stage of the company

Describe Kids Learn AI as an early-stage startup building a repeatable program. Do not imply a large team, guaranteed long-term employment, or guaranteed VFC funding. The candidate should understand that the role combines teaching, experimentation, and practical curriculum work.

What to say about the role

SAY THIS

"The position is Curriculum and Content Support / Instructor Intern. It is remote and approximately ten hours per week, usually two hours per day from Monday to Friday. Mondays and Wednesdays are the fixed live-class responsibilities: the new beginner cohort and the continuing Term 2 cohort. I will be present and co-supervising during child-facing sessions. The other days focus on curriculum work such as creating exercises, testing lessons, improving explanations, and preparing future course content."

SAY THIS

"The pay is twenty dollars per hour through payroll. The placement is connected to Venture for Canada and compensation is contingent on approved funding for this specific hire. Before any child-facing work, we require references, a vulnerable-sector check, and safeguarding onboarding."

SAY THIS

"You will be encouraged to use AI as a working tool for brainstorming, drafting activities, researching examples, and improving lesson material. However, AI output is never treated as final. You are responsible for checking technical accuracy, age appropriateness, originality, privacy, and alignment with our curriculum. Children's personal information must never be pasted into an AI tool."

What success looks like

- Students feel safe asking questions and trying again after errors.
- Explanations are technically correct but understandable to a 9- to 13-year-old.
- Live classes are interactive, paced well, and prepared in advance.
- Curriculum drafts arrive on time and improve through feedback.
- The intern communicates schedule issues early and documents work clearly.
- Safeguarding and privacy rules are followed without exceptions.

Confirm the candidate understood

SAY THIS

"Before we move into questions, what part of the role sounds most interesting to you, and is there anything about the schedule or responsibilities you would like me to clarify?"

Opening and motivation questions

00-03 | Welcome

SAY THIS

"Thanks for making time today, [Name]. I read your application and noticed [specific detail]. I would like to spend about thirty minutes learning about your background, checking how you explain Python, and giving you a short teaching exercise. Then we will discuss logistics and leave time for your questions. Does that sound good?"

03-08 | Ask two motivation questions

Tell me about a time you explained something technical to someone who knew nothing about it. What did you do when they did not understand the first explanation?

Listen for: A real example; patience; a second strategy such as an analogy, visual, demonstration, or smaller steps. Repeating the same words more slowly is weak evidence.

You could pursue a development or research internship. Why does teaching appeal to you, and why do you want to work with children?

Listen for: Specific interest in children, education, mentorship, or confidence-building. Generic career-benefit answers are weaker.

What experience have you had with children or teenagers? Tutoring, camps, coaching, volunteering, and family experience can all count.

Listen for: A concrete situation and an honest account of what was difficult. No formal experience is not automatically disqualifying if the mini-teach is strong.

From a 10-year-old's point of view, what makes an online class genuinely engaging?

Listen for: Short active segments, doing more than listening, questions, choices, visible progress, and psychological safety around mistakes.

Tell me about a time you received feedback that changed how you worked or taught.

Listen for: Coachability, ownership, and a specific change. Watch for defensiveness or an example where the feedback was dismissed.

Useful follow-ups

- What did you do next?
- How did you know the learner understood?
- What would you do differently now?
- Can you give me a specific example?

Notes

Python fundamentals and live debugging

08-14 | Pick one explain-it-simply question

What is the difference between a variable and a list? Explain it to an 11-year-old.

Listen for: A clear analogy and accurate distinction: one named value versus an ordered collection of values.

A student asks, 'Why do we need functions if the code works without them?' What would you say?

Listen for: Reuse, organization, and naming explained through a familiar example such as a recipe, dance move, or game action.

Walk me through what happens in `for i in range(3):` as if I have never seen a loop.

Listen for: Correctly explains that i takes 0, 1, and 2, while keeping jargon under control.

Live debugging exercise - paste this into the chat

```
score = 0
name = input("What is your name? ")
if name = "Ada":
    print("Welcome back, " + name)
    score = score + 10
print("Your score is " + score)
```

PROMPT

"A student wrote this and says, 'It is broken.' Talk me through exactly what you would say to the student, rather than simply telling me the answer."

Interviewer answer key

- Bug 1: line 3 uses `=` instead of `==` in the comparison.
- Bug 2: the last line tries to combine a string with an integer. Use `str(score)` or an f-string.
- Strong teaching behavior: asks the learner to read the error, isolates one line, gives a clue, celebrates progress, and lets the learner make the change.
- Weak teaching behavior: announces both fixes immediately, sounds annoyed, or makes the error feel embarrassing.

Technical notes

Mini-teach, classroom judgment, and safeguarding

14-20 | Mini-teach - do not skip

SAY THIS

"Now the fun part. Pretend I am ten years old and I have just learned about variables, but nothing else. Take about four minutes and teach me what an if-statement is. You may talk, type, draw, or use any method you would use in a real class. Take one minute to think first if you would like."

During the lesson, interrupt once

- Wait, what does the colon do?
- I do not understand. Can you say it another way?
- What happens if the condition is false?

Score the mini-teach on

- [] Hook: starts from a child's world, not syntax.
- [] Check-ins: asks questions and checks understanding instead of monologuing.
- [] Recovery: responds warmly and changes approach after your interruption.
- [] Accuracy: simplifies without saying something false.
- [] Camera energy: could hold a 10-year-old's attention in an evening Zoom class.

20-24 | Pick one classroom scenario

A student's code will not run. They are visibly frustrated and say, 'I am just bad at this.' What do you do in the next sixty seconds?

Listen for: Addresses emotion first, normalizes debugging, breaks the problem down, and creates a quick win.

One child finishes every exercise in two minutes and begins distracting others. What do you do?

Listen for: Uses extension challenges or a structured helper role while protecting the rest of the class.

A student asks a Python question live and you do not know the answer. What do you say?

Listen for: Admits uncertainty and models how to investigate. Bluffing is a serious concern.

A shy student keeps their camera off and never speaks. After two classes, what would you try?

Listen for: Low-pressure participation through chat, polls, written work, and private coordination with the founder or parent - not forcing the camera on.

Mandatory safeguarding question - ask verbatim

SAY THIS

"Because we teach children, we use strict safeguarding rules: I am present in every session, there is no private messaging or one-on-one contact with learners outside class, and child-facing work requires references plus a vulnerable-sector check. How do those rules sit with you?"

Listen for: immediate, comfortable agreement and an understanding that these rules protect learners, families, and instructors. Hedging or resistance is a hard stop.

Logistics, eligibility, and candidate-specific prompts

24-28 | Confirm these aloud

- [] Are you currently enrolled at an accredited Canadian college or university, and will you remain enrolled for at least the first 30 days of the placement?
- [] Does your application correctly state that you meet the Venture for Canada participant-status requirement?
- [] Are you at least 18 years old? A yes or no is sufficient.
- [] Can you consistently commit about two hours per weekday, including the fixed Monday and Wednesday live-class times? What does your fall timetable look like?
- [] Do you have reliable internet, a working camera and microphone, and a quiet place for live classes?
- [] Are you comfortable providing references and completing a vulnerable-sector check before working with children?
- [] Do you have any family, close personal, or close business relationship with me or Opyjo Consulting Inc.?
- [] Do you understand that the rate is \$20 per hour and that this placement is contingent on approved VFC funding?

Keep eligibility questions narrow

Verify the program requirements, but do not ask about ethnicity, place of birth, religion, marital or family status, pregnancy, health history, disability details, or an exact date of birth. Ask whether the candidate can perform the role and whether an accommodation is required only through the appropriate hiring process.

Candidate quick-reference prompts

Candidate	Known strength	Best tailored question
Ali Mohamed	Advanced Python; K-12 Mathnasium instruction; curriculum-aligned lesson preparation.	Tell me about a Mathnasium learner who was disengaged or stuck. How did you adapt the lesson in the moment?
Ishani Thakker	Advanced Python; UCMAS tutor; UofT CS teaching assistant for 120+ students.	How would you change your teaching style when moving from university students to a 10-year-old beginner?
Abdullah Awan	Advanced Python; directly taught ages 8-14 Python and Scratch.	Describe one child you taught Python. What was difficult, and how did you know your approach worked?
Atabong Eyambe Mokom	Advanced Python; Computer Science background; no teaching experience listed.	What makes you confident you can teach children, and what would you need to learn quickly in your first two weeks?

Answering their questions and closing the call

Likely candidate questions - suggested answers

What does a normal week look like?

Listen for: About two hours per weekday. Monday and Wednesday focus on preparing for and delivering live classes. Tuesday, Thursday, and Friday focus on curriculum design, exercises, testing, and review.

Will I teach alone?

Listen for: No. The founder is present and co-supervises child-facing sessions. Responsibility can grow with training, but safeguarding and quality controls remain in place.

What training will I receive?

Listen for: Onboarding covers the curriculum, platform, live-class workflow, safeguarding, privacy, lesson preparation, and how feedback is given.

Can I use AI for the curriculum work?

Listen for: Yes, as an assistant for ideas and drafts. Every output must be checked, adapted, and reviewed. Children's personal data must never be entered into AI tools.

How flexible is the schedule?

Listen for: Curriculum hours can work around classes, but the Monday and Wednesday live-class windows are fixed and must be protected.

Is the internship guaranteed?

Listen for: No offer is final until candidate fit, references, checks, and VFC funding approval are complete. Be transparent about this.

28-30 | Invite their questions

SAY THIS

"Those are all my questions. What would you like to know about Kids Learn AI, the students, the curriculum, or the internship?"

Closing script

SAY THIS

"Thank you, [Name]. I am finishing interviews this week. If we move forward, the next steps are reference checks, confirmation of VFC requirements, a vulnerable-sector check before teaching, and onboarding and safeguarding training. Either way, I will update you by [date]. Thank you for the conversation."

Do not make an offer during the call

Even if the interview is excellent, score the candidate after the meeting and compare candidates consistently. You can say the conversation was strong without promising an outcome.

Printable scorecard

Candidate:

Date:

Interviewer:

Decision by:

Dimension	1 - weak	2	3	4 - strong	Score
Python fluency	Shaky fundamentals; missed bugs			Fluent fundamentals; found bugs; explains simply	___/4
Kid communication	Jargon-heavy; lecture mode			Warm analogies; checks understanding	___/4
Teaching instinct	Gives answers; rattled by interruption			Guides discovery; adapts calmly	___/4
Reliability	Vague schedule; weak preparation examples			Clear fit; organized and proactive	___/4
Motivation & safety	Generic interest; hesitates on rules			Genuine teaching pull; embraces safeguards	___/4

Total: _____ / 20

Decision guide

17-20: advance to offer track. 13-16: hold and compare. 12 or below: decline. Any score of 1 in kid communication, teaching instinct, or safeguarding comfort is a no regardless of total.

Evidence and notes

Decision flags and post-interview checklist

Green flags	Hard flags
• Turns debugging into coaching • Asks about students and curriculum • Says 'I do not know' and investigates • Uses child-friendly analogies • Enjoys the mini-teach • Gives specific reliability examples	• Resists safeguarding or checks • Bluffs technical answers • Condescends to children • Cannot meet VFC requirements • Cannot attend fixed classes • Uses AI output without verification • Treats child privacy casually

Within 10 minutes after the call

- [] Complete the scorecard before reading another candidate's application.
- [] Write two or three evidence-based notes: one strength, one concern, and one follow-up.
- [] Record any unresolved schedule, eligibility, reference, or safeguarding issue.
- [] Update the application status to Interviewed.
- [] Do not store unnecessary sensitive personal information in interview notes.
- [] Send the promised update by the date stated in the closing script.

Final recommendation

☐ Advance	☐ Hold	☐ Decline
Reason:		

Your north star

Choose the candidate you would trust to make a frustrated child feel capable, while keeping the lesson accurate, organized, safe, and aligned with Kids Learn AI's standards.